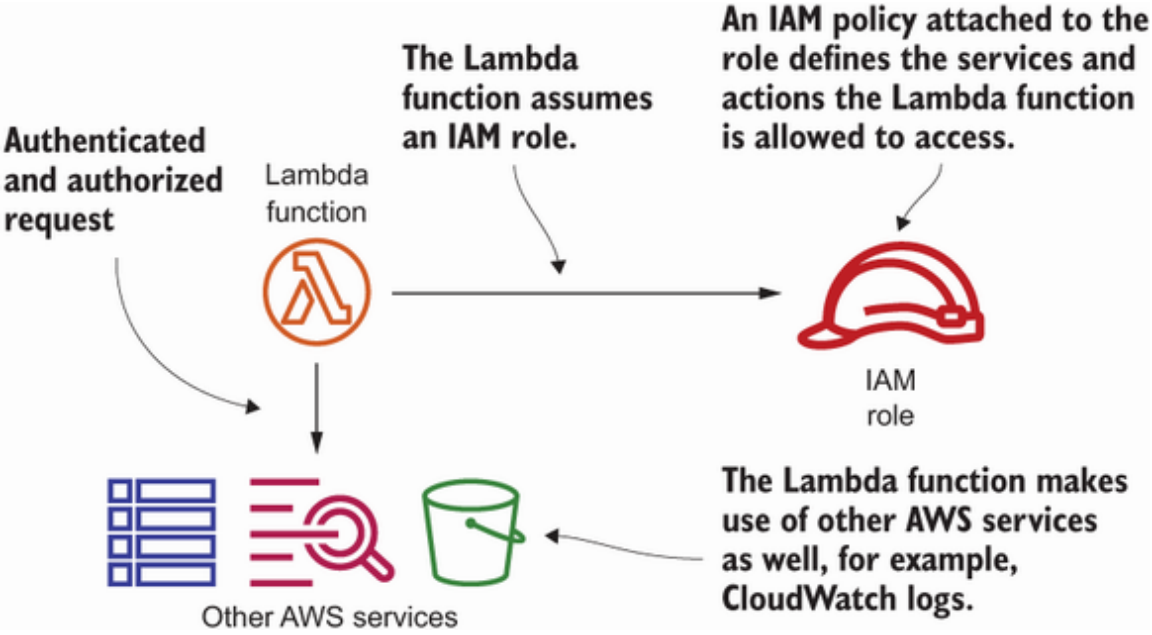


Figure 6.19 A Lambda function assumes an IAM role to authenticate and authorize requests to other AWS services.

Temporary credentials are generated based on the IAM role and injected into each invocation via environment variables (such as `AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID`, `AWS_SECRET_ ACCESS_KEY`, and `AWS_SESSION_TOKEN`). Those environment variables are used by the AWS SDK to sign requests automatically.

You should follow the least-privilege principle: your function should be allowed to access only services and actions that are needed to perform the function's task. You should specify a detailed IAM policy granting access to specific actions and resources.

Listing 6.6 shows an excerpt from the Lambda function's CloudFormation template based on SAM. When using SAM, an IAM role is created for each Lambda function by default. A managed policy that grants write access to CloudWatch logs is attached to the IAM